

Setting up the Google Drive connection

START-SYS · for Danielle Quiambao (CCDO) · no technical background needed · about 20 minutes

What you need: the START-DOST Gmail account — the same one the system sends email from.

What you'll end up with: three values to send Ethan.

At the end, START-SYS will be able to place approved members' documents into a Google Drive folder that you own and can open normally.

Before you start. Make sure you are signed into Google as the **START-DOST account**, not your personal one. Everything below attaches to whichever account you are signed in as, and it is very hard to move afterwards. If you are not sure, sign out of everything and sign back in with just the org account.

Part 1 — Make the folder 2 minutes

1. Go to **drive.google.com**
2. Click + **New** → **New folder**
3. Name it **START-SYS Member Documents**
4. Open the folder by double-clicking it
5. Look at the web address bar at the top of your browser. It looks like:

```
https://drive.google.com/drive/folders/1a2B3cD4eFgHiJkLmNoPqRsTuVwXyZ
```

6. Copy **the part after** `folders/` — in the example that is `1a2B3cD4eFgHiJkLmNoPqRsTuVwXyZ` . Paste it somewhere safe. This is **Value 1 — Folder ID**.

Leave the folder empty. The system fills it.

Part 2 — Create the project 3 minutes

1. Go to **console.cloud.google.com**
2. If it asks you to agree to terms, agree
3. At the very top of the page, next to "Google Cloud", click the **project dropdown** (it may say "Select a project")
4. Click **NEW PROJECT** in the top right of the popup
5. Project name: **START-SYS**
6. Leave everything else as it is. Click **CREATE**
7. Wait about 20 seconds. A notification appears when it is done — click **SELECT PROJECT**

You should now see **START-SYS** at the top of the page. If you do not, click the project dropdown again and pick it. **Nothing below works unless START-SYS is the selected project.**

Part 3 — Turn on Google Drive access 2 minutes

1. In the search bar at the very top, type **Google Drive API**
2. Click the result named **Google Drive API** (under "Marketplace")
3. Click the blue **ENABLE** button
4. Wait for it to finish

Part 4 — Set up the permission screen 6 minutes

This is the screen that appears once, later, asking permission for START-SYS to use Drive.

1. In the search bar at the top, type **OAuth consent screen** and click that result
2. Choose **External**, then click **CREATE**

"External" sounds wrong but is correct — "Internal" only exists for paid Google Workspace accounts, and ours is a regular Gmail account.

3. Fill in the form:
 - **App name:** `START-SYS`
 - **User support email:** pick the START-DOST address from the dropdown
 - Skip the logo and all the optional boxes
 - **Developer contact information:** type the START-DOST email address again
4. Click **SAVE AND CONTINUE**
5. On the **Scopes** page, click **ADD OR REMOVE SCOPES**
6. In the filter box, type: `drive.file`
7. Tick the checkbox on the row that ends in `.../auth/drive.file`

The description reads roughly "See, edit, create and delete only the specific Google Drive files you use with this app." That is exactly what we want — it means START-SYS can only touch files it created itself, and can never see the rest of your Drive.

Do not tick any other Drive row. The ones called `drive` or `drive.readonly` give access to your whole Drive, and we specifically do not want that.

8. Click **UPDATE**, then **SAVE AND CONTINUE**
9. On the **Test users** page, just click **SAVE AND CONTINUE**
10. Click **BACK TO DASHBOARD**

Part 5 — Publish it 1 minute — do not skip

This is the most important step in the whole document. If it is skipped, the connection silently stops working after 7 days and nobody gets an error message.

1. You should be on the **OAuth consent screen** page
2. Find **Publishing status**. It currently says **Testing**
3. Click **PUBLISH APP**
4. A confirmation box appears — click **CONFIRM**
5. Check that Publishing status now says **In production**

If it asks anything about "verification" or "submit for verification" — **ignore it and close it**. We do not need verification, because the permission we asked for in Part 4 is a limited one. The app works published-but-unverified.

Part 6 — Create the keys 4 minutes

1. In the search bar at the top, type **Credentials** and click that result
2. Click + **CREATE CREDENTIALS** at the top → choose **OAuth client ID**
3. **Application type**: choose **Desktop app**
4. **Name**: `START-SYS Setup`
5. Click **CREATE**
6. A box pops up showing **Client ID** and **Client secret**. Copy both.
 - **Value 2 — Client ID** (long, ends in `.apps.googleusercontent.com`)
 - **Value 3 — Client secret** (shorter, usually starts `GOCSPX-`)

You can also click **DOWNLOAD JSON** to save them. If you lose them, come back to this Credentials page and click the client name — the Client ID is always visible, and you can generate a new secret.

Part 7 — Send Ethan the three values

Send these **privately** — a direct message to Ethan. Not a group chat, not a Messenger group, not a public channel.

Value	Where it came from
Folder ID	Part 1
Client ID	Part 6
Client secret	Part 6

The **Client secret is a password**. Anyone who has it, plus the Client ID, can ask for access to that Drive folder. Treat it the way you would treat the account password.

What happens next

Ethan runs a one-time step that opens a Google permission page. You may need to be signed in as the START-DOST account for that, or hand him access — coordinate with him.

On that page you will see **"Google hasn't verified this app."** This is expected. Click **Advanced**, then **Go to START-SYS (unsafe)**. It is safe — it is the app you just created, and it can only touch its own files.

After that it is done permanently. No weekly renewal, no re-doing this.

If something goes wrong

What you see	What it means	Fix
"To view this page, select a project"	START-SYS is not the selected project	Click the project dropdown at the top and pick START-SYS
Publishing status still says Testing	Part 5 did not take	Redo Part 5. This one matters — it breaks after 7 days otherwise
Cannot find <code>drive.file</code> in the scopes list	Drive API is not enabled	Redo Part 3, then come back
Asked to "submit for verification"	Normal for our kind of app	Close it. Not needed
You accidentally used your personal account	Everything attached to the wrong account	Tell Ethan before going further — easier to redo than to move